

Your boss ranks overruling AI above using it

IBM asked 1,500 HR chiefs and 8,800 employees which skill matters most. They disagree by 33 points.

SWIPE →

EXECUTIVES WHO RANK SUPERVISING AND OVERRIDING AI FIRST

71%

Among employees, 38% say the same. A 33-point gap on the one skill the people who write job descriptions rank highest.

01 Prompting is not the scarce skill

Prompt tips are everywhere and cost nothing to copy. Knowing when the answer is wrong is the thing the survey says employers are short of.

02 Your own skills are slipping quietly

60% of employees told IBM they worry their skills are eroding. The one they name most often is critical thinking, the exact skill being asked for.

Two ways to use the same tool

DEFERRING

Accept the draft, send it on, hope the numbers hold up.

SUPERVISING

Check the claim that carries the risk, then send it with a note on what you checked.

03 Most firms never drew the line

Only 26% clearly define which work is human-led and which is AI-assisted. Until that is written down, the person who overrides the model carries the risk alone.

“

**Employees stop
deferring to the
machine and start
supervising it.**

IBM INSTITUTE FOR BUSINESS VALUE, 2026

Where HR shares ownership of that boundary,
76% of those organisations report staff feel safe to
question or override AI.

DO THIS TODAY

Find the part you cannot verify

Take one AI answer you accepted this week. Mark the claim that would cost most if it were wrong. Check that one. The habit is the skill.

One idea, decoded, every week

Plain English, a named source, and one thing to do with it.

Decoding AI

FOLLOW FOR THE NEXT ONE